

BERLIN
GERMANY



EPISODE

23

THE COLLECTOR'S CABINET

23: Two Drawers

二つの引き出し



Achtung!
Betreten verboten
Lebensgefahr!



Das Cabinet
Im Leben

Polizei, Anhalten

THE DRAWER MECHANISM: A LEGACY IN LOCK AND BLOOD.

FELIX SCHREIBER • ASTRID BRANDT • INOUE



FILE: C23-TD

S2.5300* N. 13.4050* E
REF: SCHREIBER ARCHIV



6 356500 030350 9



KREUZBERG, BERLIN
DEALER'S SHOP

I WILL SPEAK
PLAINLY, DR. BRANDT.
MR. SCHREIBER.

I HAVE BEEN
APPROACHED BEFORE
BY PEOPLE CLAIMING
INHERITANCE TO WHAT
I HOLD IN THE CELLAR.

TWO OF THOSE
PEOPLE WERE LYING.

ONE OF THEM
NEARLY GOT ME
ARRESTED.

I WILL NOT SO MUCH
AS UNLOCK THE
CELLAR STAIRS
UNTIL I HAVE PROOF
NEITHER OF YOU IS
A THIRD.

THEN
LET'S START
WITH PROOF.

WE
UNDERSTAND.

MY GRANDFATHER'S
NOTES.

SPECIFIC PAGE.
AS REQUESTED.

THE KEY-FRAGMENT.

GERMAN. DRAWER
MECHANISM.
19TH CENTURY.

I HAVE SEEN
ENOUGH TO KNOW
THIS COULD BE
REAL.

I HAVE ALSO
SEEN ENOUGH TO
KNOW IT COULD
BE ANOTHER LIE.

THE CELLAR STAIRS
REMAIN LOCKED.

TRUTH HAS A WEIGHT

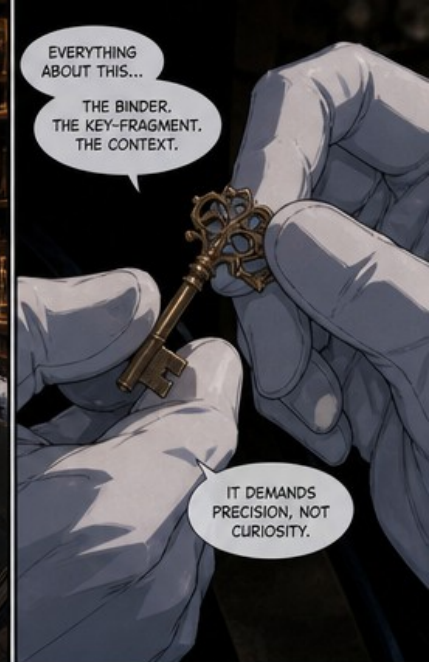
— SHOPFRONT, FRONT ROOM —



I ALWAYS WEAR GLOVES.

NOT OUT OF PARANOIA.

OUT OF RESPECT.



EVERYTHING ABOUT THIS...

THE BINDER.
THE KEY-FRAGMENT.
THE CONTEXT.

IT DEMANDS
PRECISION, NOT
CURIOSITY.



I DON'T BELIEVE
THE CABINET IS CURSED.

OR MAGICAL.

NOT IN THE WAY YOUR
GRANDFATHER'S
GENERATION
SOMETIMES SPOKE
OF IT.

BUT I HAVE WATCHED
WHAT HAPPENS TO PEOPLE
WHO GO NEAR IT
CARELESSLY.

I HAVE PERSONALLY
CATALOGUED THREE CASES
OF COLLECTORS...

...AND ONE
JOURNALIST.



EVERY ONE OF THEM—
WITHIN A YEAR OF
FORCING ONE OF ITS
DRAWERS WITHOUT
BEING A LEGITIMATE
HOLDER—

THEIR LIVES
CAME APART.



I HAVE CONCLUDED,
PROFESSIONALLY,
THAT THIS SHOULD
BE HANDLED...



EXACTLY LIKE
UNEXPLODED ORDNANCE
FROM THE WAR STILL
OCCASIONALLY SURFACING
IN THE CITY'S
CONSTRUCTION SITES.

REAL.

DANGEROUS.

AND NOT INTERESTED
IN YOUR INTENTIONS.



TRUTH-SIGHT: ACTIVE

LIE: NONE DETECTED
INTENT: PROTECTIVE
HISTORY: VERIFIED
EMOTION: CAUTION EARNED

NO DECEPTION.
ONLY THE WEIGHT OF
CATALOGUED CONSEQUENCE.
HE SPEAKS FROM EXPERIENCE.
I ACKNOWLEDGE IT.

KREUZBERG, BERLIN
PRESENT DAY

I'VE LOOKED.
THE BINDER.
THE KEY-FRAGMENT.

BOTH ARE OLD.
BOTH ARE REAL.

BUT LEGITIMACY...
THAT'S NOT SOMETHING
I CAN LOOK UP.

SO HERE'S MY
ACTUAL TEST.

I WANT ASTRID BRANDT
AND FELIX SCHREIBER TO
EACH INDEPENDENTLY DESCRIBE
A SPECIFIC DETAIL FROM YOUR
FAMILY HISTORIES.

SOMETHING ONLY A LEGITIMATE
LINE-HOLDER COULD KNOW.

AND SOMETHING THAT HAS
NEVER, TO MY KNOWLEDGE,
BEEN WRITTEN DOWN ANYWHERE
I HAVE ACCESS TO.

ASTRID BRANDT
LINE: BRANDT
ROLE: CLAIMANT

MY
GROSSVATER
USED TO SAY
THIS ABOUT
THE BINDER.

"DIT DING IS'
JUT WIE EIN ALTER
HUND—JE MEHR
DIT FÜTTERST, JE
WENIGER SACHEN
VERRÄT ER DIR."

* TRANSLATION;
"THIS THING IS LIKE AN OLD DOG—
THE MORE YOU FEED IT, THE
FEWER THINGS IT TELLS YOU."

BERLIN DIALECT:
ONLY SOMEONE
RAISED BY HIM
WOULD GET THE
TONE AND WORDS
EXACTLY RIGHT.

THE KEY-FRAGMENT
LOOKS WORN, RIGHT?

BUT ON THE UNDERSIDE—
RIGHT HERE.

THERE'S A MAKER'S MARK.
BARELY VISIBLE.

TWO LETTERS.
OVERLAPPED.

FELIX SCHREIBER
LINE: SCHREIBER
ROLE: CLAIMANT

"V" OVER "M".
VERY FINE.
HAND-STRUCK.

I'VE NEVER
SHOWN THIS TO
ANYONE. NOT EVEN
ASTRID. NOT UNTIL
RIGHT NOW.



SUBJECTIVE POV: KAI MORI

PRESENT-TRUTH GRID

REAL-TIME ANALYSIS
FILTER: LIES / OMISSIONS / TRUTHS

SUBJECT: ASTRID BRANDT

STATEMENT ANALYSIS

DIALECT MATCH: 100.0%
FAMILY CONTEXT: VERIFIED
UNIQUENESS: CONFIRMED

TRUTH

SUBJECT: FELIX SCHREIBER

STATEMENT ANALYSIS

PHYSICAL DETAIL: VERIFIED
MARK EXISTENCE: CONFIRMED
ACCESS EXCLUSIVITY: CONFIRMED

TRUTH

BOTH
STATEMENTS:
TRUE.

NO RECORD.
NO LIES
DETECTED.

HMM.

EXACT WORDS.
EXACT TONE.
EXACT DIALECT.

AND A MARK
I'VE NEVER SEEN
DOCUMENTED.
NOT ONCE.

IMPRESSIVE.

NOW WE'RE
GETTING
SOMEWHERE.

YOU TWO
JUST PROVED
YOU'RE WHO YOU
CLAIM TO BE.

AND YOU...

YOU SAW IT
AS IT HAPPENED.

INTERESTING.



THE DEALER

Sixty years in the trade.
Reads liars for a living.

KAI MORI

Seventeen.
Reads truth
better than
most people
can lie.

REIKA TENDO

Eighteen.
Protects what
matters.
Chooses
carefully.

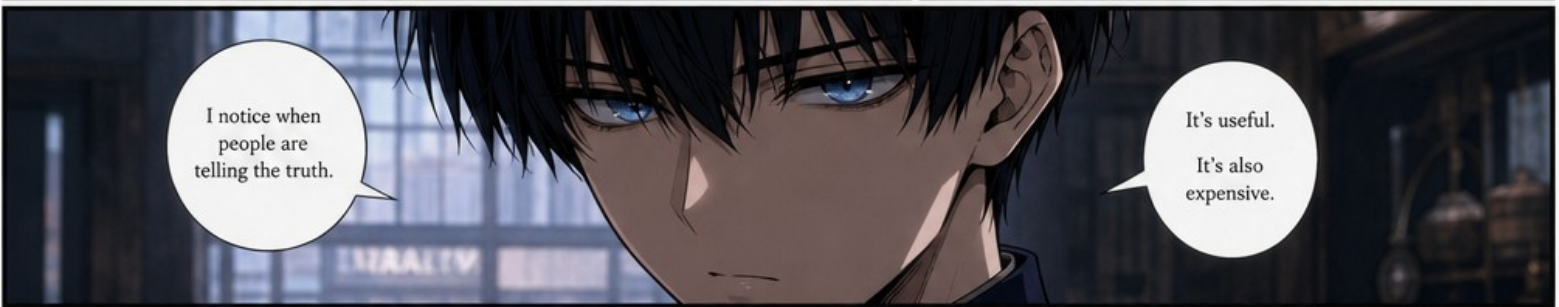


Tell me,
Kai Mori.

What exactly
are you doing
with your face
when people
speak?

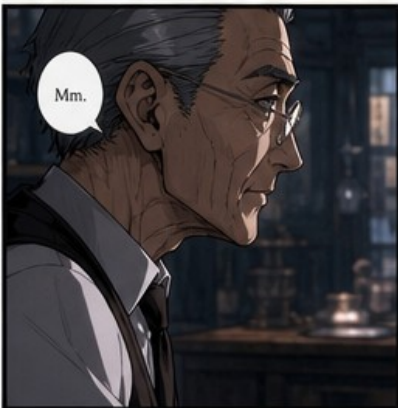


...



I notice when
people are
telling the truth.

It's useful.
It's also
expensive.



Mm.



File it.
No further
comment.
For now.

1

THE DEALER
LEADS THE WAY
DOWN, HIS LAMP
CUTTING THROUGH
YEARS OF DUST
AND STONE.

THE STAIRWAY
PREDATES THE SHOP,
BUILT INTO
FOUNDATION STONE
OLDER THAN THE
CITY ITSELF.

2

FELIX SCHREIBER
AND ASTRID BRANDT
FOLLOW CLOSE—
EACH STEP TAKEN
WITH THE CARE OF
PEOPLE WHO HAVE
WAITED YEARS...

...AND ARE,
DESPITE
EVERYTHING,
STILL AFRAID OF
WHAT WAITS
BELOW.

3

REIKA TENDO'S
TOUCH CATCHES
A FLICKER—
DECADES OF
FOOTSTEPS,
SECRETS, AND
SILENT DEBTS
ETCHED INTO
THE VERY
FOUNDATION.

TOO BRIEF.
TOO LAYERED.
TOO MUCH.
TO PARSE.

4

KAI MORI
OBSERVES.
CALCULATES.

SORA MINABE'S
VISION NARROWS—
THE WIDEST IT HAS
EVER BEEN
COLLAPSED TO A
SINGLE POINT.

NOTHING EXISTS
NOW BUT
WHAT WAITS
AT THE BOTTOM.

REIKA TENDO SEES IT AS...

...DARK LACQUERED
WOOD.

KAI MORI SEES IT AS...

...RAW PALE
TIMBER.

SORA MINABE SEES IT AS...

...SOMETHING CLOSER
TO OLD IRON THAN
WOOD AT ALL.

THE CELLAR ITSELF IS
ORDINARY—ANTIQUES, CLOCKS,
PORCELAIN, PRINTS.

NOTHING HERE IS WHAT
ANYONE CAME FOR.

AT THE CENTER:
THE COLLECTOR'S
CABINET.

WHATEVER ITS FORM,
ITS PURPOSE IS
THE SAME.

PERFECTION
IS MY ONLY
LANGUAGE.

BUT EVEN I CAN
FEEL MYSELF
DROWNING.

EVERY
VARIABLE.
EVERY
OUTCOME.

ALL OF THEM
END THE SAME
WAY.

I SEE THEM.
ALL OF THEM.

THAT'S WHY
I HAVE TO
PROTECT THEM.

I DON'T KNOW
WHAT THIS IS...

...BUT I KNOW
IT'S DANGEROUS.

AH, BUT
OF COURSE.

THAT'S WHY
WE'RE ALL
HERE.

FIVE READERS.
FIVE PERCEPTIONS.

ONE OBJECT.

ONE HUNDRED
AND TWENTY
POSSIBILITIES.

ONE PURPOSE.

THE CABINET.

THE ARCHIVE OF EVERY
DEAL EVER MADE,
EVERY SECRET PRESERVED.

SOME FAMILIES BUILD
FORTUNES.
OURS PRESERVED THE
TRUTH OF THEIRS.

TWO YEARS.
THOUSANDS OF THREADS.
COUNTLESS DEAD ENDS.

ALL LEAD HERE.

NOT OUTWARD,
BUT INWARD.
NOT ACROSS THE CITY,
BUT THROUGH DECADES
OF COMPLICITY.

EACH THREAD
A CHOICE.
EACH CHOICE
A CONSEQUENCE.
EACH CONSEQUENCE
A PATH BACK TO HIM.

ONE SYMBOL.
RESOLVES DIFFERENTLY
TO MY EYE.
ONLY MINE.

THE ACT.
THE DAY.
THE MAN.
MY GRANDFATHER.

I FOUND IT.

HE DOESN'T
MOVE TO HELP.
HE KNOWS.

THIS PART
IS MINE.

SOME DOORS
ONLY OPEN
FOR THE ONES
WHO EARNED
THE RIGHT TO
FIND THEM.

I DON'T OPEN IT.
NOT YET.
I ONLY CONFIRM IT.
THE STILLNESS
OF ARRIVAL.

VOLUME II

THE TWO-DRAWER TRUTH

SAME PERIOD.
TWO FACES OF THE SAME WOUND.



REIKA TENDO, 18
THE READER OF THE PAST
FIRST TIME WITHOUT GLOVES.
FIRST TIME THE TRUTH
ANSWERS BACK.

BIBLE CANON • VOLUME II
"SAME PERIOD, TWO FACES OF THE SAME WOUND."

1.

HER FINGERS PAUSE
OVER A DRAWER
DISTANT FROM ASTRID'S.
THE SYMBOL RESOLVES—
TO HER EYE ALONE—
INTO SOMETHING
HALF-RECOGNISED.



2.

CONTACT.
DELIBERATE.
CHOSEN.
NO ACCIDENT
THIS TIME.



3.

A PAST-FLASH.
NOT A FLOOD—
BUT CONFIRMATION.
HER GREAT-
GRANDMOTHER'S
HANDWRITING.
FOR ONE INSTANT—
PROOF.



4.

THE TWO-DRAWER
TRUTH.
NO LONGER THEORY.
BUT PHYSICAL FACT.
BENEATH
HER OWN HAND.





IT WON'T
OPEN.

NOTHING
MOVES.

IT
REFUSES
US.



AS
PREDICTED.

THE CABINET
DOES NOT RESPOND
TO BLOOD ALONE.

IT RESPONDS
TO PAYMENT.

THEY HAVE
NOT YET PAID.

OTHERS HAVE
TRIED.

ALL WITH
THE SAME
RESULT.

HYPOTHESIS:
CONFIRMED.



THE DRAWERS
ARE NOT LOCKED
AGAINST THE
WRONG HOLDERS.

THEY ARE LOCKED
AGAINST HOLDERS
WHO HAVE NOT
YET PAID—

—WHATEVER
THE CABINET
REQUIRES.

THE REFUSAL
ITSELF IS
LEGIBLE.

THIS, TOO,
IS INFORMATION.



GRANDFATHER
KNEW THIS DAY
WOULD COME.

HE LEFT
SOMETHING
AT THE END.

I JUST
HAVE TO
FIND IT.



PROOF OF
LINEAGE
MEANS NOTHING
WITHOUT PAYMENT.

THE CABINET
IS NOT A VAULT.

IT'S A
LEDGER.

DEBT
UNPAID.

PERMISSION
DENIED.

THE THRESHOLD
REMAINS
CLOSED.

1.

ZWEI JAHRE.
ZEILE FÜR ZEILE.
KEIN DURCHBRUCH.
NUR VERTRAUTHEIT.
BIS ES NACHGIBT.

2.

DIE ENTSCHÜSSELUNG
ÜBERLAGERT DAS
ORIGINAL.

Das Cabinet öffnet sich nicht für Touristen.
Es öffnet sich nur für die,
die bereit sind,
im selben Feuer nackt zu stehen.
Du musst deine eigene
ruinierte Geschichte
auf das Holz legen.

3.

DIE ÜBERSETZUNG.
KLAR.
UNMISSEVERSTÄNDLICH.
ENDGÜLTIG.

The Cabinet does not open for tourists.
It only opens for those willing
to stand naked in the same fire.

You must put your own
ruined history on the wood.

4.

EIN BRIEF,
GESCHRIEBEN
JAHRZEHNTE
VOR IHRER GEBURT.
GEKOMMEN
GENAU DANN,
WENN SIE IHN
BRAUCHT.

DIE SCHWINDEL,
BEI DER EINE
NACHRICHT, DIE FÜR SIE
GESCHRIEBEN WURDE,
SIE ENDLICH
ERREICHT.

行き先は「断罪の遺跡《ダンザイノイセキ》」。
開く方法は――

Our destination is the "Ruins of Damnation"
The way to open it is――

「産土の楔《ウブスナクサビ》」を
四つ、祭壇の基底に据え、
心臓の形を成すよう配置する。

その時、扉は目覚める。

Place the four "Ubusuna
Wedges" at the base of
the altar, arranged to form
the shape of a heart.

Then, the door will awaken.

カタ...

KAI MORI

The catalogue opens.
Names. Dates. Coordinates.
Things I will never say aloud.

Every variable. Every cost.
Every truth that stays buried.

REIKA TENDO

So it is this one.
The ruins our family was
meant to keep sealed.

All the lives built on the lie
that we succeeded.
The guilt is inherited.
The choice is mine.

SORA MINABE

If that door opens...
Everything changes.

I see it.
All of it.
And none of it
has a happy ending.

FELIX SCHREIBER

The key answers.
And the weight is mine
to carry.

Not a flinch.
Just the part
that I was given.

THE DEALER

This is not my story
to witness.
Their truths.
Their choices.

I step back.
Respect is the only
currency that matters.

Five reactions.
One instruction.
Five truths
converging in
the dark.

The ruins
are waiting.
So are we.

THE CELLAR.
DEALER'S WIFE
REACHES
EVERYWHERE.

DEALER_NET_5G

SIGNAL: WEAK
BUT STABLE

KAI MORI

森海

17才

INOUE HANA
TOKYO, JAPAN

14:37
(GMT+9)

THE CABINET
WANTS US TO
UNCOVER THE
TRUTH BURIED
IN THE HAKUSHO
BLOODLINE.

REIKA'S PART
WILL BE...
NECESSARY.

HER BLOODLINE
IS THE KEY.

AND BECAUSE OF
WHAT THAT BLOODLINE
REPRESENTS—

REIKA WILL HAVE
TO STAND IN THE OPEN.
TO ACCEPT THE SHAME
THAT COMES WITH IT.

THOUSANDS OF
KILOMETERS
AWAY.

AND HE'S
ASKING ME TO
WITNESS HER
SHAME.

TO BE PART OF
IT.

AFTER
EVERYTHING
HE OWES
ME.

I COULD
SAY NO.

I SHOULD
SAY NO.

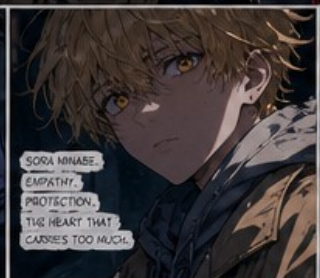
BUT IF I
LOOK AWAY
AGAIN—

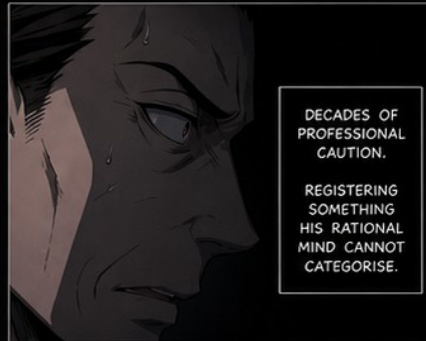
WHAT DOES
THAT MAKE
ME?

I...
I'LL STAY
ON THE
CALL.

ISOLATION IS
THE PRICE

OF SPEAKING
THE TRUTH
ALoud.





DECADES OF
PROFESSIONAL
CAUTION.

REGISTERING
SOMETHING
HIS RATIONAL
MIND CANNOT
CATEGORISE.



THE DEALER
STOPS MID-STEP.

BACKS QUIETLY
THE REST OF
THE WAY UP.

WITHOUT
A WORD.

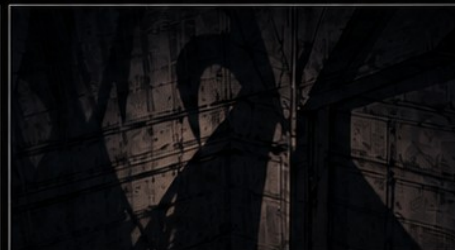
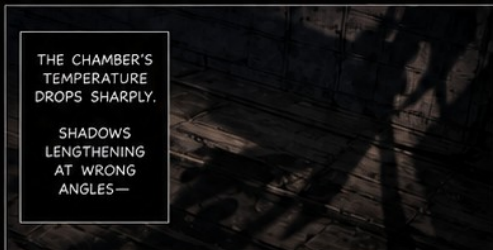


GUTTER

GUTTER

THE CHAMBER'S
TEMPERATURE
DROPS SHARPLY.

SHADOWS
LENGTHENING
AT WRONG
ANGLES—



EXACTLY AS
ESTABLISHED
IN EPISODE 21'S
APARTMENT.

EPISODE 22'S
BROADCASTING
HALL.

BUT HERE—
FOR THE FIRST
TIME—

VELETH HAS BEEN
WAITING SPECIFICALLY
FOR THIS ROOM.

AND THIS MOMENT.
ACROSS THE
ENTIRE ARC.



THE SIX-PERSON
CRUCIBLE ASSEMBLED.

THE CABINET'S TWO
IMMOVABLE DRAWERS
WAITING BETWEEN
THEM.

BEFORE A SINGLE
CONFESSION CAN
BE SPOKEN—

IT HAD BEEN WAITING A VERY LONG TIME
FOR SOMEONE TO FINALLY ASK IT TO
STOP HIDING.

Cut to black.